



# AGENT HACKATHON

*Microsoft Student Ambassador Program 2026*



## **Team Members:**

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# WHY EXCHANGE MATTERS

A transformative experience trapped in a fragmented process



## 5,400+

students go on outbound exchange every year across Hong Kong's 8 UGC-funded universities (2019/20)

Source: Statista / UGC



## 2,600+

exchange agreements signed by HK's UGC-funded universities with partner institutions worldwide

Source: Times Higher Education, 2024



## +23 pts

higher likelihood of employment within 3 years for study-abroad graduates vs. non-mobile peers

Source: IZA World of Labor

## ⚠ BUT APPLICATION IS A HUSTLE WITH NO CENTRALIZED GUIDANCE

One exchange case need at least 6 sperate login

1 Home Uni Nomination



2 Exchange Application



3 Housing (CEDARS)



4 Visa Application



5 Immigration Department



6 Course Enrolment

From our initial survey (N= 21),

**33%** are concerned about **credit transfer eligibility**

"It could affect my graduation timeline if the course credit cannot be transferred"

**25%** struggle to meet **application deadlines**

"I am overwhelmed by a number of deadlines"

**17%** fear they may not secure **accommodation** in time

"I don't know where to look for accommodation, and I'm worried everything affordable will be gone before I apply."

**To unlock the full value of exchange, students need a centralized end-to-end platform that guides them from preparation to departure**

Pain Points

Solutions

User Journey

Architecture

Implementation Plan

Impacts

# SOLUTIONS

Addressing the highest-friction moments across the exchange journey



## School Mapping

*Matches students with partner universities based on their academic focus, language preference, and destination goals*



## Host Country Explore

*Delivers curated insights on culture, cost of living, safety, climate, and daily life for the chosen host country*



## Course Mapping

*Automatically compares home and host university modules, flagging mismatches and suggesting equivalent alternatives*



## Mock Interview

*Builds confidence and sharpens responses for exchange interviews*



## Application Planning

*Breaks down every deadline, document requirement, and submission step into a personalised, timed checklist*

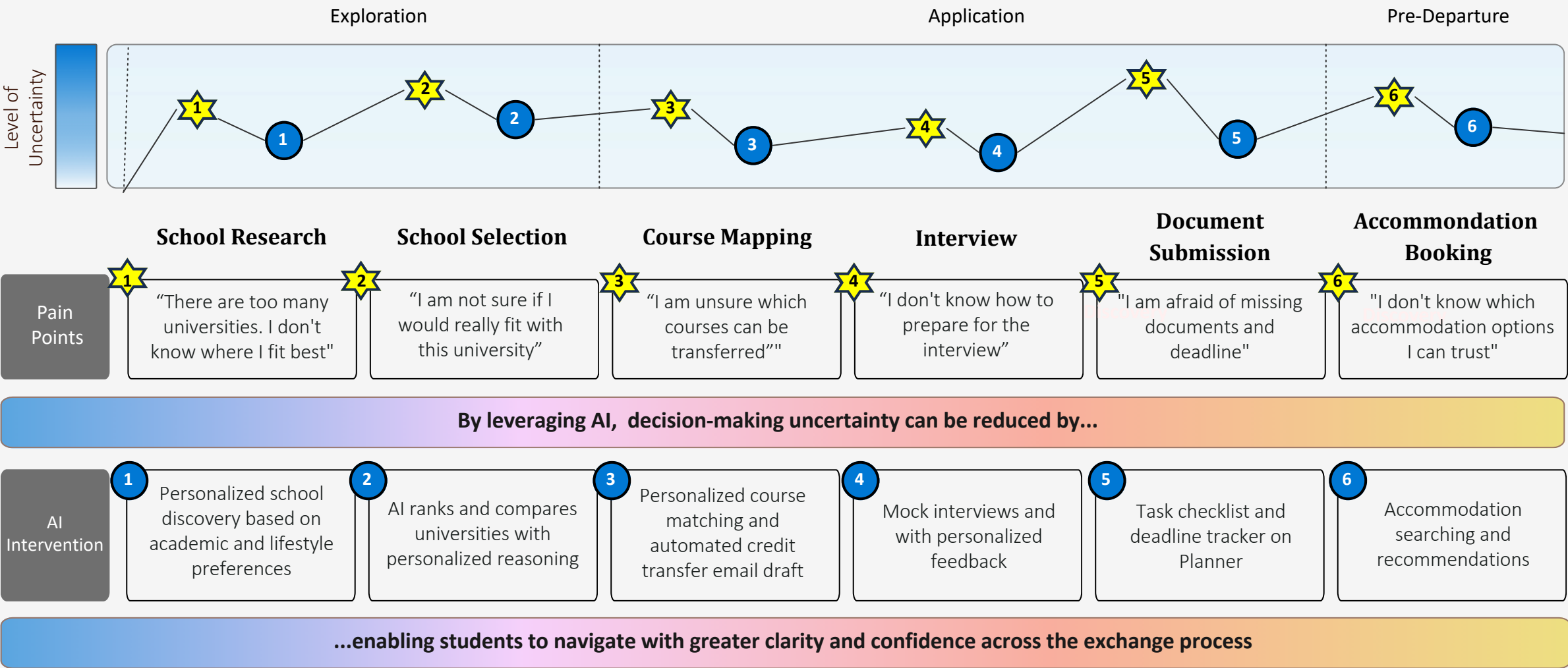


## Accommodation Search

*Saves weeks of stressful searching and helps students secure safe, affordable housing faster*

# USER JOURNEY

From school discovery to accommodation booking, AI reduces uncertainty at every stage of the exchange journey



Pain Points

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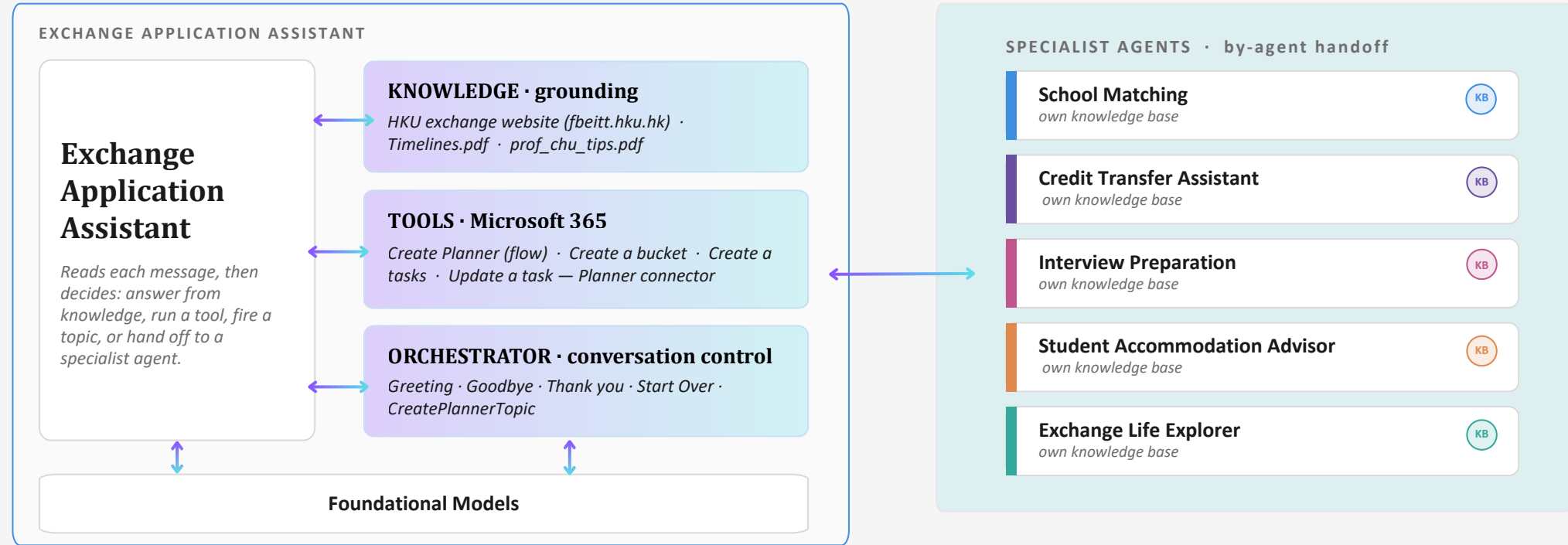
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# AGENT ARCHITECTURE

A modular multi-agent architecture that combines trusted knowledge, workflow automation, and specialized expertise



1

## Modular Multi-Agent Design

Domain-specific agents encapsulate distinct business logic and knowledge, enabling higher accuracy, easier maintenance, and scalable feature expansion.

2

## Trusted Knowledge Grounding

Agent responses are grounded in verified HKU resources, ensuring consistency, transparency, and reduced hallucination risk.

3

## Workflow Automation via Microsoft 365

Planner integration converts recommendations into actionable tasks, creating a seamless bridge between guidance and execution.

4

## Orchestrated Request Routing

An orchestration layer classifies user intent and routes requests to the most appropriate topic, tool, or specialist agent for efficient resolution.

Pain Points

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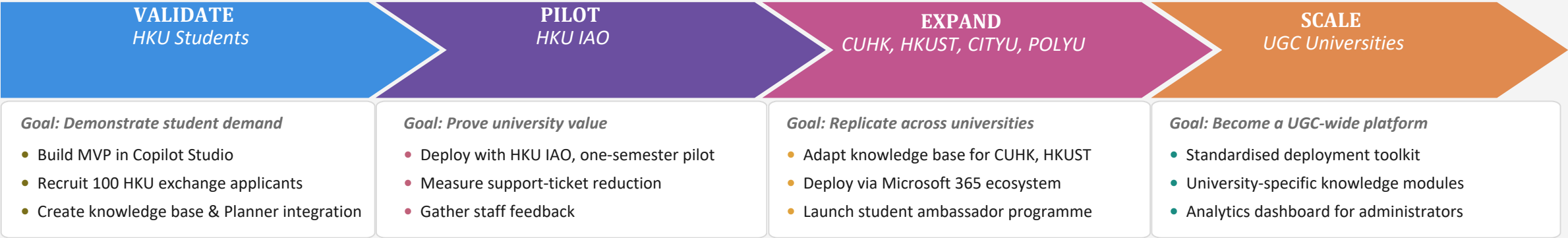
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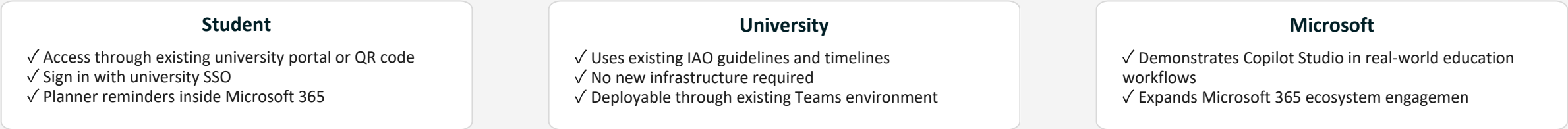
# IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

A phased rollout strategy designed to validate demand, prove institutional value, and scale across universities

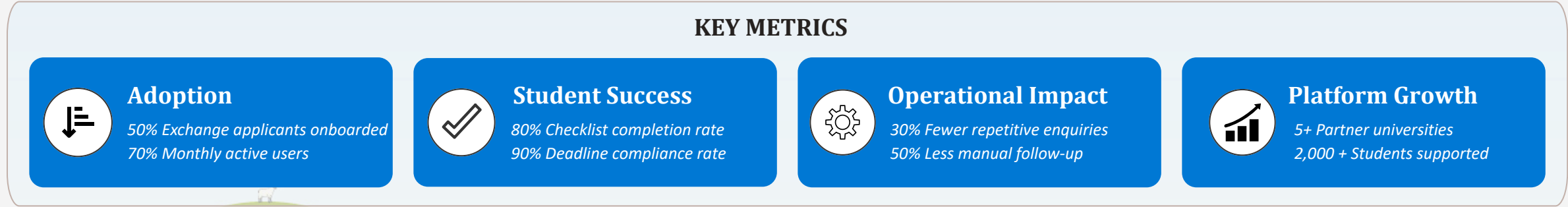


## LOW-FRICTION ADOPTION STRATEGY

Seamless Integration with Existing Infrastructure



## KEY METRICS



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# RISKS& MITIGATION

Scaling responsibly through trust, governance, and control



| Risk                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Magnitude                                                                                                                                                                                         | Mitigation                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div><div>1</div><div><b>University Adoption &amp; Institutional Trust</b></div><div>Universities may be hesitant to endorse or deploy a student-facing AI assistant due to concerns around reliability, governance, and reputational risk.</div></div> | <div><div>Probability</div><div><div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div><div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div><div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div></div><div>Impact</div></div> | <div><ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Demonstrate measurable outcomes before wider deployment</li><li>• Position the assistant as a support tool rather than a decision-making authority</li></ul></div>         |
| <div><div>2</div><div><b>Cross-University Standardization Risk</b></div><div>Exchange policies, timelines, and procedures differ across institutions, making it challenging to deploy a single solution consistently.</div></div>                       | <div><div>Probability</div><div><div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div><div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div><div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div></div><div>Impact</div></div> | <div><ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Provide configurable templates for deployment across institutions</li><li>• Establish governance guidelines for content ownership</li></ul></div>                          |
| <div><div>3</div><div><b>Privacy, Security &amp; Regulatory Compliance</b></div><div>The assistant may process sensitive personal information related to applications, visas, and academic records.</div></div>                                         | <div><div>Probability</div><div><div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div><div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div><div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div></div><div>Impact</div></div> | <div><ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Apply role-based access controls and university SSO authentication</li><li>• Minimize storage of personally identifiable information (PII)</li></ul></div>                 |
| <div><div>4</div><div><b>Student Adoption &amp; Behaviour Change</b></div><div>Students may continue relying on informal channels such as Reddit, WhatsApp groups, or peer advice instead of the assistant.</div></div>                                 | <div><div>Probability</div><div><div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div><div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div><div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div></div><div>Impact</div></div> | <div><ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Embed access directly into existing student touchpoints (exchange portal, Teams, QR codes)</li><li>• Launch a peer ambassador programme to drive awareness</li></ul></div> |